

Compound and Complex Sentences

USA Grade 3 ELA
CCSS L.3.1.I

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING TARGET

I can produce simple, compound, and complex sentences.

KEY STRATEGY + WORKED EXAMPLE

A compound sentence joins two complete ideas. A complex sentence joins an independent clause with a dependent clause.

I packed lunch, and Mia filled the bottles. Because it was warm, we carried water.

A. TRY TOGETHER - USE THE STRATEGY

1. Simple, compound, or complex: Birds sing.
2. Classify: Birds sing, and squirrels chatter.
3. Classify: When dawn arrives, birds sing.
4. Name the conjunction in the compound example.

B. CORE PRACTICE - SHOW YOUR WORK

5. Join with and: I read. I took notes.

6. Join with but: The sun shone. The air was cold.

7. Complete: Because the trail was muddy, ____.

8. Complete: ____ before the bell rang.

9. Classify: We stayed inside because rain fell.

10. Classify: I called, but no one answered.

11. Is this complete? Although we hurried.

12. Repair the fragment in question 11.

C. INDEPENDENT FLUENCY - CALCULATE AND CHECK

13. Add a comma: After lunch we rehearsed.

14. Choose and/but: I was tired, ____ I finished.

15. Choose because/so: We left early ____ traffic was heavy.

16. Combine: Kai cooked. Noor washed dishes.

17. Write one simple sentence.

18. Expand it into a compound sentence.

19. Expand it into a complex sentence.

20. Underline the dependent clause: If you listen, you will hear owls.

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D. APPLY THE SKILL

21. Revise the choppy text: I woke. I dressed. I missed the bus.

22. Explain why 'Because I was late.' is a fragment.

23. Write three connected sentences using all three sentence types.

E. REASON, CHECK AND CORRECT

24. How does sentence variety improve writing?

25. Can a sentence contain two verbs and still be simple? Give an example.

EXIT TICKET + CHALLENGE

26. Classify and punctuate: When rain stops we will play.

Challenge: Turn four simple sentences into a smooth paragraph containing one compound and one complex sentence.

F. STUDENT REVIEW - SHOW WHAT YOU UNDERSTAND

Use your own words so your teacher can see what you understand and what to practise next.

27. Explain one strategy you used today.

28. Check one answer in a different way.

29. Circle one: I understand it | I need more practice | I need help

30. The easiest part was: _____

31. The most difficult part was: _____

Why was it difficult? _____

32. My next practice step is: _____

TEACHER COPY - ANSWERS AND SUPPORT

ANSWER KEY

A. 1) simple. 2) compound. 3) complex. 4) and. 5) I read, and I took notes. 6) The sun shone, but the air was cold. 7-8) Answers vary with complete clause. 9) complex. 10) compound. 11) no. 12) Answers vary, such as Although we hurried, we missed the bus. 13) After lunch, we rehearsed. 14) but. 15) because. 16) Kai cooked, and Noor washed dishes. 17-19) Answers vary. 20) If you listen.

B. 21) Answers vary; combine ideas logically. 22) It contains a dependent clause but no complete independent clause. 23) Answers vary.

C. 24) It improves flow and shows relationships among ideas. 25) Yes; Birds swoop and glide.

D. 26) complex; When rain stops, we will play.

Challenge: Answers vary. Check that the student's example follows every condition and that the reasoning is mathematically correct.

F. 27-28) Answers vary. Look for a clear strategy and a valid second check. 29-32) Use the reflection to identify confidence, difficulty and the next teaching step.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Students may identify a sentence by length. Classification depends on clauses, not the number of words.

TEACHER CHECK

- ☐ Uses an appropriate Grade 3 ELA strategy.
- ☐ Shows or explains thinking clearly.
- ☐ Checks a response using evidence, a rule, or a second method.
- ☐ Identifies a specific difficulty and useful next practice step.

PARENT / TEACHER TIP

Ask the child to explain how they know, not only state an answer. Have them point to the text evidence or language rule, then revise one response aloud.

NEXT STEP

Revisit the item the child marked difficult. Model one example, solve one together, then ask the child to complete one independently and explain the strategy.